

Tables in HTML

Structure tabular data with rows, headers, cells, and spanning.

1. Creating Tables

Use the `<table>` element to create an HTML table. A table is built from rows, header cells, and data cells.

Element	Purpose
	Defines a table row.
	Defines a table data cell.
	Defines a table header cell.

Basic Table Example

```
<table>
  <tr>
    <th>Name</th>
    <th>Age</th>
  </tr>
  <tr>
    <td>Alice</td>
    <td>24</td>
  </tr>
  <tr>
    <td>Bob</td>
    <td>30</td>
  </tr>
</table>
```

Result: A two-column table with the headers Name and Age, followed by rows for Alice and Bob.

2. Adding Borders

The source introduces the **border** attribute to add a visible border to a basic table.

```
<table border="1">
  ...
</table>
```

Modern practice: CSS is generally preferred for controlling table borders and visual styling.

3. Table Headings vs. Data

Element	Role
	Table heading; typically rendered bold and centered by browsers.
	Regular table data.

4. Spanning Columns and Rows

Use **colspan** and **rowspan** when one cell needs to extend across multiple columns or rows.

Column Span Example

```
<table border="1">
  <tr>
    <th colspan="2">Employee Details</th>
  </tr>
  <tr>
    <td>John</td>
    <td>Manager</td>
  </tr>
</table>
```

Row Span Example

```
<table border="1">
  <tr>
    <td rowspan="2">John</td>
    <td>Manager</td>
  </tr>
  <tr>
    <td>IT Department</td>
  </tr>
</table>
```

5. Practical Tips

TIP — KEEP TABLES READABLE

- Keep your tables organized and easy to read.
- Use **<th>** for important headers that identify rows or columns.
- Avoid using complex tables for page layout; use CSS for page design instead.

Quick Reference

Concept	HTML
Table	
Row	
Header cell	
Data cell	
Merge columns	<code>colspan="n"</code>
Merge rows	<code>rowspan="n"</code>

Quick Takeaway

Remember: **<table>** contains **<tr>** rows, while **<th>** and **<td>** represent header and data cells. Use **colspan** or **rowspan** when cells need to span multiple columns or rows.